



FINAL EXPENSE Life Insurance
SALES PRESENTATION ©

Old Leads “Intro” Script / Spike Questions

www.FinalExpenseSuccess.com ©

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The secret to selling is to *sell the secret.* ©

(Explaining your product should sound like the
“best kept secret”
in the entire insurance industry.
Make qualifying for one of your plans a
“mystery of anticipation”.)

Troy G. Clark, Ph.D.

Life ♦ Insurance

1809, Noun

Providing payment of a stipulated sum
to a designated beneficiary
upon death of the insured.

Merriam-Webster's Dictionary
11th Collegiate Version 3.0, 2003

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FINAL EXPENSE SELLING POINTERS

**Because this “selling” script is to be adapted to field or phone sales for salesmen/women, please consider the following additional pointers to owning a superior Sales Presentation Script:*

- Old leads indicate any lead that has already been contacted by a previous agent. An old lead could also be a virgin lead over 30 days from the customer’s initial inquiry.
- A customer’s reaction to an agent typically equals the agent’s own selling disposition. That is, what an agent transfers over the phone, or in person, to a customer, is mostly how a customer treats an agent. If an agent exudes an unenthusiastic, low voice volume, or frustrated disposition, the customer will react to the agent with a low interest level of enthusiasm, or negative disinterest. If an agent treats his/her customer to enthusiastic, professional, upbeat, positivity, and authoritative cheer, the customer will more likely “perk up”, pay attention, and listen with interest.
- RECORD YOURSELF giving a sales presentation to a “pretend customer”. Listen to your recording. Would you buy a policy from YOU? If not, why should your customer? Always improve **how you sound** while delivering a sales presentation!
- This Sales Presentation Script works best if your prospect customer previously responded to some type of lead inquiry (Ex: Mailer, Telemarketer, TV, etc.) giving the customer an opportunity to respond for more information on final expense coverage.
- Because many people need professional assistance to overcome procrastination, seniors without any, or little, life insurance coverage put their family at risk of a burden of approx. \$7,000-\$12,000 immediate funeral bill, if they should pass away at any moment.
- Many people living on savings, Social Security, or Disability, are unable to afford large, expensive-type life insurance plans. Helping these folks to make a right decision that would fit into their individual lifestyle, and budget, is important. A large funeral bill, outstanding credit card debt, nursing care bills, etc., puts financial stress on a surviving spouse or children of the deceased. Final Expense Insurance is a wonderful way to individually eliminate this burden on an entire family.
- In this Sales Script Manual, the term “Licensed Field Underwriter” should only be applied to an agent who has previously secured permission from an insurance carrier to do so, while selling their product. Otherwise, replace the term “Licensed Field Underwriter” with “Final Expense Representative”.

Selling Techniques To Avoid

1. **Twisting** involves convincing a client to replace an existing policy, or switch insurance companies, through misrepresenting the existing policy's terms and values. Never tell a prospective client that your policy benefits will do something, knowing that it will not do it. Never tell a prospective client that their existing policy will not do something without reviewing their actual policy first.
2. A **Rebate** is illegal for both the agent and the consumer. An inducement offered (anything of value) not specified in the agent's policy contract within an insurance purchase agreement is a rebate. It is illegal for any person to offer or accept such an inducement.
3. An agent may not charge in excess of the policy premium for the performance of the agent's service.
4. It is also a misdemeanor to the agent in most states to transact a contract that is unlawfully executed. That is, soliciting and transacting business with a non-licensed company.
5. Knowingly making false statements on an application is punishable in most states as a Class I felony. This includes insurance agents, physicians in charge of medical checks, or applicants of life insurance. A blank application cannot be signed legally by an agent. Exceptions may be travel accident insurance, or a baggage loss policy, intended for issuance through a coin-operated machine.
6. Refrain from "hustling" or "badgering" a customer with untrue or unkind remarks, i.e.: "This is your last chance to ever qualify for these benefits", "Don't be a fool, sign up today", "If you wait another day to apply for this coverage, your chance will be lost forever."
7. Inherent within the insurance industry, unfortunately, are licensed agents whose only concern is to position a potential client to "sign on the dotted line" at all cost. To do so, a dishonest agent may withhold important, deal breaking information from the customer about a certain policy feature that may influence the customer's decision one way or another. For example, if a plan for coverage has a 2-3 year "waiting period" before 100% of the natural death benefits goes into full force, the customer should know this up front during the initial explanation of the benefits. If the "waiting period" is not properly and thoroughly explained at the time of purchase by the sales agent, a family may get surprised by the sting of having a fraction or zero coverage they were counting on, if the client passes away during the 2-3 year "waiting/elimination period". Up front honesty by the agent always wins more success in the long run.
8. Misrepresenting your product, or the product of another company that a customer is currently insured with, is detrimental to both parties involved and is no way to begin a lifelong, trusting business relationship. A customer is more likely to buy from a forthright, honest agent, who holds nothing back from the customer. There must be no "surprises" later to the customer or agent. On the flip side of this coin is manipulating a customer to buy insurance based upon untrue or over-the-top explanations of policy benefits. An agent must never promise a customer that their policy will do something that it will not do. We officially term this "twisting" of the facts in insurance terminology. If a professional agent is unsure how to explain policy benefits, or how to answer a customer's question about benefits, a correct response would be:

"That's a good question. Let me make sure I can give you an accurate answer by looking it up for you. Because I am a professional, I do not want either of us to be surprised later by giving you a guess answer. We'll come back to that later, I promise."

An Insurance Commissioner may revoke, suspend, or deny licensure to any individual for:

- ☹ Cheating on the State Licensing Exam.
- ☹ Fraud.
- ☹ Misrepresentation of policy terms.
- ☹ Violation of any insurance law.
- ☹ Misappropriation of funds.
- ☹ Conviction involving moral turpitude or any felony.
- ☹ Violation of the Unfair Trade Practice.
- ☹ Coercive or dishonest practices.
- ☹ Forging names on an application.
- ☹ Failure to comply with continuing education requirements.

Old Leads “Intro” Script

**Although an agent follows the same Sales Presentation Script at www.finalexpensesuccess.com for “older” leads that is normally utilized for “new” leads, the initial up front introduction is key to opening up a conversation. Because a “older” lead customer may have been contacted by a previous agent, it is important for the next agent to make a different appeal to the customer than the original agent. That is, approach your customer in a “follow up” manner, not as an original call. For example, an expert agent never says, “I received your card in the mail requesting information...”, because that is precisely how the previous agent introduced himself to the customer. Here are various, effective talking points of introduction for a “older” lead:*

Hi, (Customer First Name). This is (Agent Name) from a final expense department.

- **We are following up on your request for benefits here at my department.**
- **As supervisor of approved benefits, it is my job to follow up with your case.**
- **Our records here indicate that you have not yet received the benefits you requested.**
- **Did someone contact you already about the information you requested?**
- **Why was the previous representative not able to help you apply for your benefits?**
- **We’d like to know - Did you want the benefits for yourself, or may we have your permission to share the benefits with someone else?**

**Always listen for the customer’s challenge, objection, or reason why they did not move forward with the original agent. Usually a customer will let an agent know what happened right up front. This is key! Now, the current agent can handle the customer’s buying obstacle right up front! Take a quick assessment. If the customer’s obstacle can be overcome, here are effective talking points for an agent to utilize:*

- **This is not a problem. I am sorry that you have not been able to move forward with the benefits that you are entitled to here. I can take care of it for you right now!**
- **Let’s see exactly what you qualify for.**
- **May I get this fixed for you right away?**
- **I apologize for the previous representative who was not able to help you. It is my job to follow up with you, and make sure you get all the benefits you are entitled to here.**
- **It is a good thing you are talking to me now. I will be able to secure top benefits for you available right now in (Customer City).**

**Pivot to the “Verify Customer Information” page in the Sales Presentation Script at www.finalexpensesuccess.com. Start there! Close the Sale!!*

Spike Questions

**To invoke curiosity throughout your sales presentation, ask additional questions that “spike” customer interest, scattered throughout your script delivery.*

***Your benefits should sound like an untold “mystery” to the customer. Intriguing. Captivating! Your final expense plan should initially come across as the “best kept secret” in the entire funeral protection industry. Interject words picture and questions that invoke curiosity:*

- **Are you aware that we have no-cost, extra benefits in your area that come to you directly by applying for one of our plans?**
- **Did you know that as a Licensed Field Underwriter, I can qualify folks who have been rejected and refused by almost everyone else?**
- **Remind me to share with you later how your entire funeral is paid for, after only one premium payment!**
- **Did you know that we have the technology at my department, so that NO PAPERWORK is required for you to fill out, if you qualify for one of our plans here?**
- **Don’t let me forget to share with you how your entire family, and some friends, may also receive benefits, without having to send a card in to my department.**

****These thought-provoking questions create intrigue in the customer’s mind, as never-before-heard-of benefits that an agent may explain in greater detail later, if a customer proceeds forward. Make qualifying for one of your plans a “mystery of anticipation”. This keeps the customer on the “edge of their seat” and eager to move forward with you!*

More Publications
by
Dr. Troy Clark

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